

Introduction

Today's talk is about keeping our waste in the right skips, wearing the right PPE while we handle it, and keeping the work area clear. The three go together. Mixed skips cost the job money, and loose steel, nails and offcuts are what cut hands and trip people.

Separating waste in the skips

- Timber goes in the timber skip. Steel goes in the steel skip. Never mix them.
- Check the sign on the skip before you load it. If you are not sure, ask your supervisor.
- Steel includes tie wire, bar offcuts, steel banding, bolts, clips and any other metal fittings.
- Take nails and screws out of timber, or bend them over, before it goes in the timber skip.
- A skip with the wrong material in it can be rejected or charged as mixed waste. That costs the job money.
- Do not overfill. Nothing should stick up above the top, and loose pieces must not blow or fall out.
- Never throw waste from a deck or platform into a skip. Carry it down or lower it safely.
- Never climb into or onto a skip. Keep well clear when a skip is being lifted or moved.
- Follow the site signs for everything else, such as packaging and general waste.

PPE

- Mandatory at all times: hard hat, hi-vis, safety boots, Level 3 cut gloves and safety glasses.
- Wear your gloves every time you handle steel or timber, even for a quick job.
- Glasses on when you are cutting, breaking up or sorting waste. Tie wire and offcuts fly.
- Boots with sound soles protect you from nails. Replace worn boots.
- FFP3 dust mask when sweeping up or handling dusty waste.
- Never carry sharp steel in bare hands or in your pockets.

Housekeeping

- Sort your waste as you go, not at the end of the day.
- Keep walkways, stairs and access routes clear of offcuts, bar ends, tie wire and banding.
- Stack reusable timber and steel neatly in the designated area, away from edges and openings.
- Keep the area around the skips clear so people and lifting vehicles can get in and out.
- Never leave waste on a slab edge. It falls on the people below.
- Sweep up small pieces of tie wire and nails. They end up through boots and in hands.

Common problems on site

- Timber thrown into the steel skip because it was the nearest one.
- Nails left sticking out of timber, in the skip or on the floor.
- Skips overfilled so that material falls off the top.
- Gloves left off for a two-minute job.
- Offcuts left on the deck to deal with later.

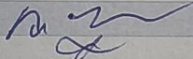
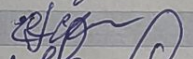
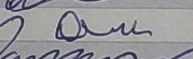
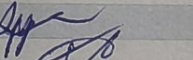
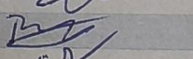
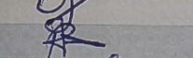
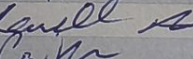
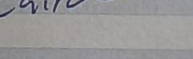
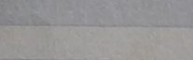
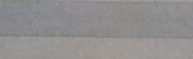
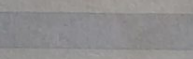
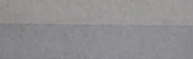
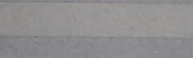
Questions and discussion

- Does everyone know which skip is for what, and are they all clearly signed?
- Is there anywhere on site where waste is building up or blocking a walkway?
- Does anyone need new gloves, glasses or boots?

Conclusion

Right waste in the right skip, the right PPE and a tidy work area stop most cuts, trips and rejected skips before they happen. If a skip is full, wrongly loaded or unsafe, stop, report it and ask your supervisor.

Reference	NBF-TBT-003	Date	06/10/26
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